



LIONS LIGHT ACADEMY

First Day Run-Through

What to cover with every student, in order

“It is the glory of God to conceal a matter, but the glory of kings is to search it out.”

PROVERBS 25:2

EFFECTIVE

September 15, 2026

DOCUMENT

2026–2027

This is the one day that sets the tone for the year. Everything here takes about 50 minutes of the opening block, and it saves you the rest of the year in corrections you won't have to make.

We talk through safety rather than running scheduled drills, which makes this walk-through our drill. Do it properly once and every student can answer "where do we go" without being told.

Before Students Arrive

Adults, 8:15 — thirty minutes early on this day only.

- Walk the building yourself. Know your exits and the route from your room to the shed
- Confirm the first aid kit's location and that you know it
- Know who is Incident Lead today — Damian or Ginny — and that they are your medical response
- Have your roster on paper. Not on a phone
- Set out name tags for every student. First names, large enough to read across a room

One adult is assigned to walk at the back of the group during the building walk-through so no one drifts.

8:45 • Arrival & Name Tags

Greet every student by name at the door if you can. Hand them their tag.

Students go straight to the main room. No wandering on the first day — they don't know the building yet and they will find the one door you'd rather they didn't.

8:50 • Opening — All Ages Together

Worship and prayer

As normal, and start on time. Beginning the very first day late teaches them the schedule is a suggestion.

Welcome, and why we're here

Keep it short. Two minutes, not ten.

"Welcome to Lions Light Academy. We're a co-op, which means this whole thing runs on families — your parents teach, they volunteer, they set up and clean up. Nobody here is paid. Everyone here chose to be here, including you.

Our verse is Proverbs 25:2 — 'It is the glory of God to conceal a matter, but the glory of kings is to search it out.' That means God hid things in the world on purpose, and going looking for them is one of the best things you can do with a life. That's what we're doing here."

Who's who

Have every adult stand as you name them. Students need faces, not titles.

- **Damian and Ginny** — leadership, and both paramedics. If someone is hurt, these are the people you find
- **Erica** — calls 911 in an emergency
- **Savannah** — contacts parents
- **Every teacher and volunteer**, by name and what they teach

"Any adult in this building can help you. If you don't know who to ask, ask anyone."

9:00 • Safety Walk-Through

Do not do this from the front of the room. Walk it.

Fire — the whole group, on foot

1. Point out the exits in the main room
2. **Walk everyone out the route to the shed behind the building.** All of them, all the way
3. Stand at the shed and say it plainly:

"This is where we come. Every time. If you hear us say go, you leave what you're holding, you stay with your group, and you come here. You do not go back for a backpack or a coat or a phone. Nothing in that building matters more than you do."

4. Take attendance right there, at the shed, so they see how it works

5. Walk back

Ask on the way in: "Where do we go?" Get it from them, not at them. Ask a few students individually. If a seven-year-old can answer it cold, you're done.

If someone gets hurt

"Find an adult. Any adult. Damian and Ginny are paramedics — that's their actual job — so you're in good hands. Don't try to decide whether it's bad enough. Let us decide that."

Show them where the first aid kit is.

Allergies

"Some people here have food allergies serious enough to be dangerous. So: don't share food. Not because we're being strict — because you can't know what's in what. We ask families to keep snacks nut-free."

Weather

"If the weather is bad, we cancel. We don't shelter here, we just don't meet. The easy rule: if the local public school is closed, we're closed. Your parents will hear from us."

Bathrooms and where you may be

- Ask your teacher, go, come straight back
 - You are in your assigned space unless an adult sends you somewhere
 - No wandering, no exploring the building
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9:20 • What We Expect

This is the part that saves you the whole year. Say it once, clearly, to everyone.

The core of it

"Here's the deal, and it's the same for a six-year-old and a senior. Learning is your work. Your teachers teach it, your parents support it, but nobody can do it for you. You show up ready, you try, and you stay with us in the room. That's the job."

Stepping out to finish work — say this before it happens to anyone

"If you come without the work the class needs, or you fall behind, a teacher might send you to the hallway or the lounge to finish and come back in."

That's not a punishment. *Nobody writes it down, it doesn't count against you, and you're not in trouble. It just means the class can't wait for you and you need a minute. Finish it, come back, we're glad you're back."*

Saying this on day one is the difference between a student stepping out calmly in week three and a student stepping out humiliated.

How correction works

Give them the real thing, in their language.

"If you're disruptive, a teacher corrects you and we move on. That's it, that's the end of it, nobody's keeping a list."

If it keeps happening after we've corrected you, or you're disrespectful, or you didn't do the work two weeks running — that's bigger. Your parents hear about it and it gets written down. That can happen twice."

The third time, we all sit down together — you, your parents, your teacher, and us — and we work out how you come back. Not whether. How."

And if something's unsafe — you hurt somebody, you threaten somebody — that's immediate, no warnings, and your parents get called that day."

Grace, and its limit

"If something hard is going on in your life, tell your teacher. They'll work with you — they know you and they've got room for that.

What doesn't work is 'I had a rough week' every week. Your teachers can tell the difference, and so can you."

What we're actually after

"We're going to push you. Not to be hard on you, and never against each other — we don't rank anybody here. We push because you can do more than you think, and we'd rather find out what that is than let you coast.

You'll be asked to do it again. To fix it. To try the harder version. That's not us being difficult. That's us paying attention."

9:40 • Split by Age Group

Same content, different weight. Fifteen minutes each with their own teachers.

Elementary (K–5)

Repeat the fire route. Ask three different children where we go. Make it a game if you want, but get the answer out of each of them.

Cover concretely:

- Where the bathroom is and how to ask
- Where to put your coat, your bag, your lunch
- Snack times, and don't share food
- **What to do if you're lost or scared** — stand still, find a grown-up. Say it out loud
- Raise your hand. We'll always come

Keep it to fifteen minutes. They're done before you are.

Middle School (5–8)

This group will test where the edges actually are, and they'll do it in week two. So be specific now.

- The warning count is real. Two, then everyone sits down together
- Phones: state the rule plainly and state what happens when it's out
- Stepping out to finish work isn't a punishment — but doing it every week is a conversation
- **Say this:** *"You're old enough that we're going to treat you like it. That works both ways."*

High School (9–12)

Treat them as near-adults, because they are, and give them the reasoning rather than the rule.

- The full Reconciliation Process — ownership, repair, a written plan, four days back
- Why preparedness matters here specifically: a discussion class with nobody prepared isn't a class
- **Credit:** if they're documenting high school credit, what they do here is part of their record
- Grade 7 and up sign the Code of Conduct themselves — do it now, in the room, on paper
- Ask them what they want out of the year. Write the answers down. Bring them up in April

10:00 • Into the Normal Day

Regular schedule from here. Snack break, then classes.

Teachers: reset the expectation at the start of your own first class. Thirty seconds each. What this class needs, what "ready" looks like, how you'll start every week. They've just heard a lot; hearing the specific version from you is what makes it land.

End of Day, 1:30 • Cleanup & Close

- Everyone cleans. Every age. Set that pattern on day one
- Gather back together for a closing prayer
- **Ask one last time: "Where do we go if there's a fire?"** End the first day on the thing that matters most

After Students Leave

Adults, fifteen minutes. Don't skip this one.

- Who did we not reach today? Any student who seemed lost, overwhelmed, or already checked out
 - Any allergy, medical need, or support need that came up and isn't on the registration form
 - Anything about the building that didn't work — a route, a room, a transition
 - Confirm every family returned a completed registration form. Chase the gaps this week, not in October
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The One-Page Version

If you only have ten minutes, cover these six:

1. **Where we go if there's a fire** — the shed behind the building. Walk it
2. **Who to find if someone's hurt** — Damian or Ginny, both paramedics
3. **Don't share food** — allergies here are serious
4. **Learning is your work** — nobody can do it for you
5. **Stepping out to finish is not a punishment**
6. **Correct, correct, then we all sit down together** — nobody gets removed by surprise